matters of domestic service. Only the begs were at their posts, with a couple of members of the local populace. Quch Beg, Muhammad Quli, Shah Sufi and one other brave did fight well and boldly. Now some Aūzbegs were on the ramparts, and some were coming up. The four of the Babur's men ran the fastest they could to deliver the best blow to the approaches. The quartet forced them all down very strategically and delivered a harsh drubbing.

Babur observes in the *Baburnama* that Quch Beg turned out to be the best one.

On the other hand, Qarā Barlās was left alone at the *N*eedle-Makers' Gate. He too gave a good fight despite being all alone. Qutluq Khwaja and Quinazar Mīrzā were also keeping their stand firm at their posts at the Bleaching-Ground Gate. They held out well too and charged the enemy from the rear.

Once again, Qasim Beg led his braves out through the Needle-Makers' Gate, pursuing the Aūzbegs as far as Khwaja Kafsher. While returning they carried the heads of a few of them, which indicated that many were beheaded.

Babur's men had fought the storm brought by Shaybāni Khān very well despite having disadvantages in some stages. There were times when Babur was even short of sufficient men to fight at his end, but fortune swayed by his side.

Now that Shaybāni's storm was at rest, something else was to bring trouble for Babur. The time of ripening rain had come but none could bring new corn into the town. Babur and the populace along with him were stuck in the unavoidable siege as neither could get in nor get out of the town. And this long siege caused great hardships to the townspeople. It was so heartening that the destitute began to survive on the flesh of dogs and asses. Since there was little grain for the horses, the people began to feed them mulberry and elm leaves. Some people scraped dry wood and began to give the shavings after being damped to their horses.

For more than fifteen weeks, Shaybāni Khān did not come near the fort at all but had kept doing rounds from post to post.

It was midnight. Babur was lying undressed in his resting chamber and his men were off the guards. Shaybāni's men came near the Turquoise Gate and began beating the drums and shouted their war cries. The drumbeats and war cries had begun to cause great trepidation and anxiety among each,